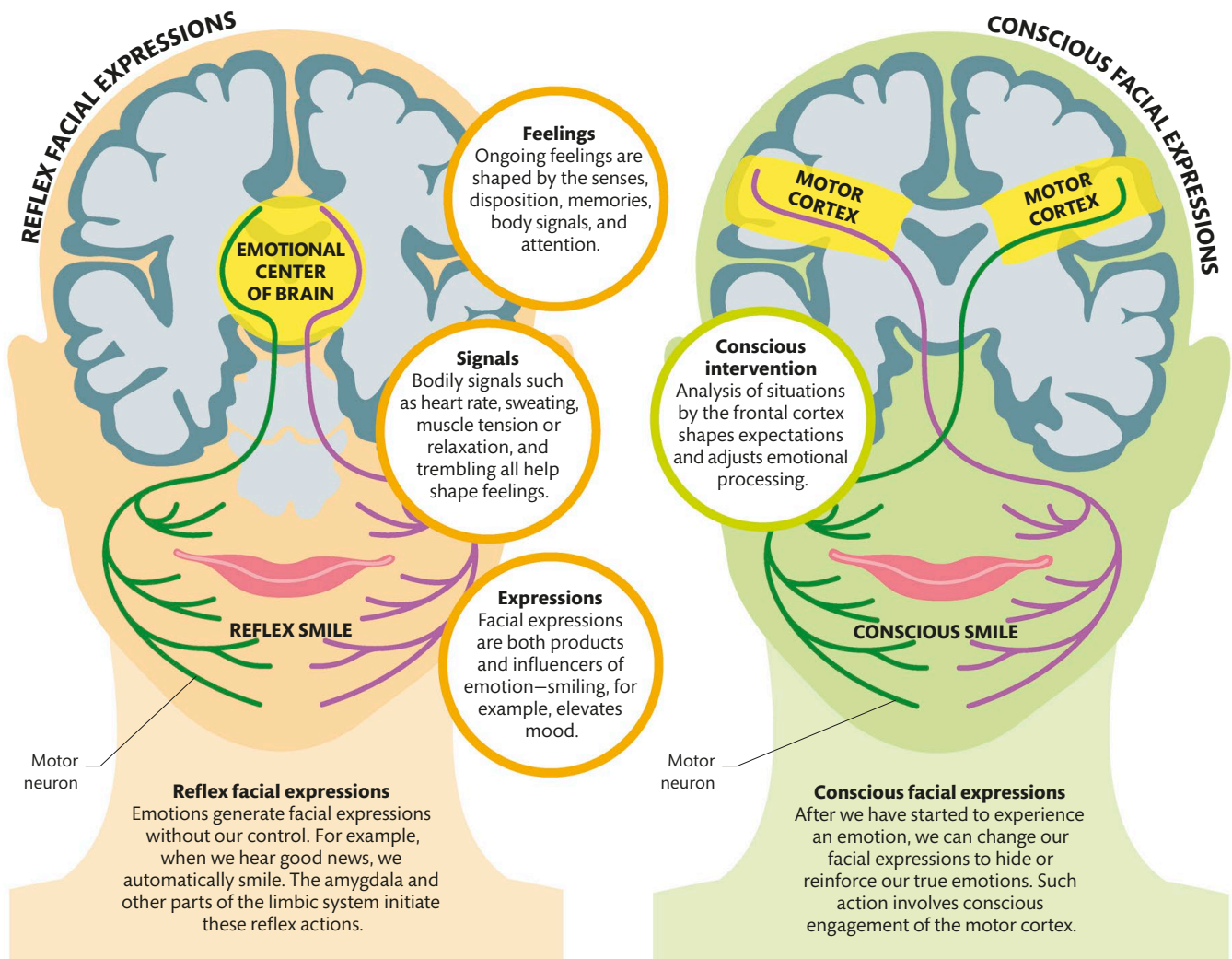




Conscious Emotion

Emotions are felt consciously, and whether they are positive or negative, changeable or constant, they have major effects on our quality of life. Conscious feelings ceaselessly interact with the unconscious processes that also shape our emotions.

How emotions form

Both reflex and conscious expressions are mediated by the motor cortex, but reflex ones are signaled to the motor area directly from the limbic system rather than via the frontal lobes. We can also consciously modify our physical responses to emotions.

Forming emotions

Emotional responses are complex and dynamic. They arise when rapid innate responses to stimuli interact with detailed analysis. Innate responses evolved as the most beneficial reactions to key stimuli. Once such stimuli have caught a person's attention, reasoned assessment follows. Then, how a person's emotions change is shaped by their disposition, past experience, and how they assess multiple streams of information.